KRISHIVAULT · FIELD WORK

Farmer Interview Guide

কৃষকের সমস্যা জানার প্রশ্নমালা — আলু চাষি, বগুড়া

Why we are doing this. KrishiVault helps potato farmers with button phones: selling for the best value, fertilizer and pesticide at a fair price and on time, seeds and machinery, and danger alerts. Before we present it, we want to hear the problems from farmers themselves. Their real answers make our problem slide stronger and check our design.

> **The golden rule.** Only real answers from real farmers go on the slides. Never invent a quote or a number. If a judge asks "how many farmers did you talk to, and where?", we must answer with what we really did.

Who to talk to

- **10 to 15 potato farmers in Bogura.** Mix char land (Sariakandi) and a central upazila.
- Small and larger farmers, **some women farmers**, and farmers with and without cold-storage access.
- About **20 minutes** each. Two of us: one asks, one writes.

Before you start: read this aloud

"আমরা ছাত্র, একটা কৃষি প্রকল্পের জন্য আপনার অভিজ্ঞতা জানতে চাই। আপনার নাম কোথাও প্রকাশ হবে না। ছবি বা রেকর্ড শুধু আপনার অনুমতি নিয়ে। আমরা কোনো টাকা বা সাহায্যের প্রতিশ্রুতি দিচ্ছি না। কথা বলবেন?"

We are students and want to learn from your experience for a farming project. Your name will not be published. Photos or recordings only with your permission. We are not promising money or help. Will you talk to us?

How to ask

- Ask an **open question first**, then ask for the number.
- **Don't suggest answers.** Ask "why did you sell then?", not "did you sell because of dadon?"
- Use their units: মণ, বিঘা, বস্তা, কেজি.
- Write **numbers**, not impressions.
- Write **exact words** for anything that could be a quote.
- Ask before every photo or recording. Mark it on the form.

How this guide is laid out

- **Pages 2 to 4:** the questions, in eight groups. ★ marks a hero question whose answer is strongest on a slide.
- **Page 5:** the answer form. Print one for each farmer.
- **Page 6:** the tally sheet, to add up the numbers after the visits.
- **Page 7:** how to turn real answers into slides, and what we expect to hear.

The questions

★ hero question · Ask in Bangla · "What it shows" says which part of KrishiVault the answer supports

A. The farmer and his phone · proves the voice-first design

#	ASK IN BANGLA	MEANING	WHAT IT SHOWS
1	কত বিঘা জমিতে আলু করেন? আর কী কী ফসল করেন?	How many bigha of potato? What other crops?	Farm size; potato plus other crops
2★	আপনার ফোনটা কেমন — বাটনওয়ালা না টাচ? ইন্টারনেট চালান?	Button or touch phone? Do you use internet?	Why KrishiVault uses calls, not an app
3	মেসেজ (SMS) নিজে পড়তে পারেন, নাকি কেউ পড়ে দেয়?	Can you read SMS yourself, or does someone read it for you?	Why voice comes first and SMS is a receipt

B. Selling · the main money leak

#	ASK IN BANGLA	MEANING	WHAT IT SHOWS
4★	গত মৌসুমে আলু কবে বেচলেন? কেজি কত টাকায়?	When did you sell last season, at what price per kg?	The harvest-glut price
5★	বেচার কয়েক মাস পরে বাজারে আলুর দাম কত উঠেছিল?	How high did the market price go a few months later?	**The price gap**, the strongest slide
6	তখনই বেচলেন কেন? টাকার দরকার, দাদন, রাখার জায়গা নেই, নাকি পচার ভয়?	Why sell then: cash need, dadon, no storage, fear of rot?	The real reasons behind forced sales
7	কার কাছে বেচেন — ফড়িয়া, আড়তদার, নাকি নিজে বাজারে? দামটা কে ঠিক করে?	Who do you sell to, and who sets the price?	Price power sits with the middleman
8★	দাদন বা আগাম টাকা নিয়েছিলেন? কার কাছ থেকে? তার কাছেই কি বেচতে হয়েছে?	Did you take dadon, from whom? Did you have to sell to him?	The dadon trap behind forced sales

C. Storage

#	ASK IN BANGLA	MEANING	WHAT IT SHOWS
9	হিমাগারে আলু রাখেন? জায়গা পান? কেজিতে ভাড়া কত দেন?	Do you use cold storage? Can you get space? Rent per kg?	Access gap; actual rent against the official rate
10	বাড়িতে রাখলে মণে কত কেজি পচে বা নষ্ট হয়?	At home, how many kg per maund rot or spoil?	Home-storage loss (checks our spoilage figure)

D. Fertilizer and seed · the input leak

#	ASK IN BANGLA	MEANING	WHAT IT SHOWS
11★	শেষবার ইউরিয়ার এক বস্তা কত টাকায় কিনেছেন? টিএসপি আর এমওপি?	What did you last pay per bag of urea, TSP and MoP?	**Overcharging.** Official urea is about ৳1,350 a 50 kg bag (confirm the current order).
12	সার সময়মতো পেয়েছিলেন? কোথাও ঘুরতে হয়েছে?	Did you get fertilizer on time? Did you have to search for it?	Shortages at planting time
13	কতটুকু সার দিবেন, কীভাবে ঠিক করেন? মাটি পরীক্ষা করিয়েছেন কখনো?	How do you decide the dose? Ever had a soil test?	Guesswork, which SRDI's soil-based dose fixes
14	বীজ আলু কোথা থেকে নেন? খরচ কত?	Where do you get seed potato, and at what cost?	The full input-cost picture

E. Risks: disease, weather, flood · the case for danger alerts

#	ASK IN BANGLA	MEANING	WHAT IT SHOWS
15★	গত মৌসুমে আলুতে কতবার স্প্রে করেছেন? কখন দিতে হবে, কে বলে?	How many sprays last season? Who tells you when?	Calendar or dealer-led spraying; the case for weather-based alerts
16	মড়ক (লেট ব্লাইট) বা কুয়াশায় কখনো ক্ষতি হয়েছে? কত মণ?	Ever lost potato to late blight or fog? How many maunds?	Size of disease loss
17	বন্যা, শিলাবৃষ্টি বা আলু তোলার সময় বৃষ্টিতে ক্ষতি হয়েছে? আগে খবর পেয়েছিলেন?	Losses from flood, hail or rain at harvest? Were you warned?	No early warning reaches farmers

F. Information and trust

#	ASK IN BANGLA	MEANING	WHAT IT SHOWS
18	দাম, আবহাওয়া বা রোগের খবর কোথা থেকে পান?	Where do you get price, weather and disease news?	Current sources (often the dealer or trader)
19	উপসহকারী কৃষি কর্মকর্তা বা ১৬১২৩ কৃষি কল সেন্টারে কখনো কথা বলেছেন?	Ever talked to the SAAO or the 16123 Krishi Call Centre?	How far existing services reach
20★	যদি একটা ফোন আসে, বাংলায় বলে "এই সপ্তাহে মড়কের আবহাওয়া, খেত দেখুন" — শুনবেন? বিশ্বাস করবেন?	Would you listen to, and trust, a call like that?	**Acceptance of KrishiVault's core channel**
21	উত্তর দিতে বোতাম চাপা সহজ, নাকি মুখে বলা?	Easier to press keys or to speak?	Keypad and voice design choice

G. Would they use the solution?

#	ASK IN BANGLA	MEANING	WHAT IT SHOWS
22	পাশের কয়েকজন মিলে একসাথে আলু বেচলে বা সার কিনলে রাজি হবেন?	Would you join a group sale or a group fertilizer buy?	Group selling and buying are wanted
23	বীজ আর যন্ত্রপাতি (পাওয়ার টিলার, হারভেস্টার) কোথা থেকে কেনেন বা ভাড়া নেন? ভালো বীজ আর সময়মতো যন্ত্র পান?	Where do you get seed, and buy or rent machines (power tiller, harvester)? Do you get good seed and machines on time?	Demand for the seeds and machinery marketplace
24	এমন সেবার জন্য মৌসুমে কিছু টাকা দিতে রাজি? কত হলে ঠিক মনে হয়?	Would you pay something per season? How much is fair?	Evidence for the business model

H. Test the prototype, and the closing question

#	ASK IN BANGLA	MEANING	WHAT IT SHOWS
25	(ডেমো কল বা অ্যাপের উত্তর শোনান) কী বুঝলেন? এখন কী করবেন?	(Play the demo call or app answer.) What did you understand? What would you do now?	**Comprehension.** Ask them to repeat the advice in their own words.
26★	একটাই সমস্যা যদি আমরা সমাধান করতে পারি, কোনটা চাইবেন?	If we could fix just one problem, which one?	The best quote for the opening slide

Closing the visit

"আপনার সময়ের জন্য ধন্যবাদ। আপনার কথাগুলো আমাদের সেবা ঠিকভাবে বানাতে সাহায্য করবে।"

Thank you for your time. What you told us will help us build the service the right way.

- Check every number on the form before you leave.
- Confirm what they agreed to: photo, voice recording, or neither.
- Give each farmer a code (F01, F02 ...). Never write the phone number on a slide.

ANSWER FORM · PRINT ONE PER FARMER

Farmer কৃষক F ____

Date

Upazila / village

Interviewers

Consent given
☐ Yes ☐ No

Photo allowed
☐ Yes ☐ No

Audio allowed
☐ Yes ☐ No

A · FARMER AND PHONE

1 · Potato land (bigha)

1 · Other crops

2 · Phone
☐ Button ☐ Touch ☐ Internet

3 · Reads SMS
☐ Self ☐ Someone reads it ☐ Doesn't use SMS

B · SELLING

4 · Sold in (month)

4 · Price ৳/kg

5 · Later market ৳/kg, month

6 · Why sold then
☐ Cash ☐ Dadon ☐ No storage ☐ Rot ☐ Other

7 · Sold to / who set price

8 · Took dadon
☐ Yes ☐ No

8 · From whom

8 · Had to sell to lender
☐ Yes ☐ No

C · STORAGE

9 · Uses cold storage
☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ No space

9 · Rent ৳/kg

10 · Home loss kg per maund

D · FERTILIZER AND SEED

11 · Urea ৳/bag

11 · TSP ৳/bag

11 · MoP ৳/bag

12 · Shortage or searching
☐ Yes ☐ No

13 · Dose decided by / soil test

14 · Seed source and cost

E · RISKS

15 · Sprays last season / advised by

16 · Blight or fog loss (maunds)

17 · Weather loss / warned before?

F AND G · INFORMATION, TRUST, SOLUTION

18 · News source

19 · Talked to SAAO / 16123
☐ SAAO ☐ 16123 ☐ Neither

20 · Would trust an alert call
☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Maybe

21 · Prefers
☐ Keypad ☐ Voice

22 · Group sale / buy
☐ Yes ☐ No

23 · Seed / machines
☐ Seed problem ☐ Rents machines

24 · Would pay ৳ per season

25 · Repeated the demo advice correctly
☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ No

26 · EXACT WORDS (BIGGEST PROBLEM, OR ANY STRONG QUOTE)

Tally sheet

Fill after the visits, one row per farmer. These columns become the numbers on the slides.

CODE	UPAZILA	PHONE (B/T)	SOLD ৳/KG, MONTH	LATER ৳/KG, MONTH	DADON (Y/N)	UREA ৳/BAG	SPRAYS	TRUST CALL (Y/N)	GROUP (Y/N)	DEMO REPEATED (Y/P/N)
F01										
F02										
F03										
F04										
F05										
F06										
F07										
F08										
F09										
F10										
F11										
F12										
F13										
F14										
F15										
Total		___ of ___ B	avg ___	avg ___	___ of ___	avg ___	avg ___	___ of ___	___ of ___	___ of ___

Turning real answers into slides

Fill these templates only with what you collected. Write the sample size every time ("of 12 farmers").

> **Voices from Bogura.** Two or three short quotes in Bangla with an English line, signed *farmer, Sariakandi* (no name unless they agree).

> **The price gap.** "Sold at ৳___/kg in [month]; the market reached ৳___/kg by [month]." Use the average across farmers.

> **Fertilizer.** "___ of ___ farmers paid more than the official ৳1,350 for a bag of urea; the average paid was ৳___."

> **The channel.** "___ of ___ use button phones; ___ would trust a Bangla alert call."

> **Dadon.** "___ of ___ took dadon; ___ had to sell to their lender."

> **Spraying.** "Average ___ sprays a season, mostly on the dealer's advice."

> **Proof the prototype works.** "___ of ___ farmers repeated our demo advice correctly."

What we expect to hear: prepare, don't quote

These come from research and news. Use them to know what to ask more about, never as farmer answers.

- **Fertilizer overcharging is common.** In August 2026, urea sold in Joypurhat for ৳1,900 to ৳1,950 a bag against the official ৳1,350 (The Daily Observer, observerbd.com/news/589247).
- **Late blight is a constant worry.** In Bogura, the weather favours late blight on about 40 days of a typical potato season (25 seasons of NASA data).
- **Many farmers sell early for cash or because of dadon**, even when they know prices will rise. Research finds that price information alone rarely raises what farmers are paid (Fafchamps and Minten, India; Aker and Fafchamps, Niger).

If what farmers tell us is different from what we expected, say so on the slides. Judges respect "we went, we listened, and we changed our design because of what farmers told us."